

making major financial decisions too early that could set us up for failure.

Brad

For me, the key to everything FI-related is flexibility and open-mindedness. This also holds true regarding my drawdown strategy once I'm past the point of FI where I'm no longer drawing income from my businesses.

I don't want to be dogmatic about anything, which is why we call the so-called 4% Rule the "4 percent rule of thumb" here at ChooseFI. Sure, there's a high likelihood that the 4 percent drawdown strategy will succeed over thirty years or more, but I can't envision a scenario where I stick to it like clockwork regardless of real-life conditions.

This is why I'm building in flexibility in two ways:

1. I'm calculating my FI number at a more conservative 3.5 percent drawdown.
2. I'm building in a buffer when calculating my yearly expenses (the starting point of calculating your FI number) that would allow us to tighten the belt and cut out some fluff from our budget that wouldn't lessen our quality of life.